



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Christ Classical Academy of Charlotte
School Website: <https://www.christclassicalclt.com/>

December 22, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Christ Classical Academy of Charlotte (CCAC) presents a clearly classical, Christian educational program. Public materials from the school emphasize Bible-centered, theologically grounded formation within a classical framework, a mission to cultivate virtue and wisdom, and a curriculum rooted in literature, writing, and critical thinking. The school's statements repeatedly connect education with formation (not merely information) and with the pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty. Across categories, CCAC demonstrates strong alignment with classical ideals, especially in religious/metaphysical foundations, school purpose/goals, and curriculum, with consistent signals in pedagogy and community partnerships. Some elements of pedagogy and faculty presentation are less explicit in public materials, which makes Element 4 (Pedagogy) and Element 5 (Faculty) somewhat less fully classical than the other categories, though still broadly aligned. The aggregate assessment places CCAC in CLASSICAL territory.

Key insights: - Religious/metaphysical foundations are explicit and central: Bible integration, chapel, and explicit theological commitments anchor the school's approach (Evidence: site descriptions of Bible classes, weekly chapel, and a philosophy emphasizing biblical truth).

- The school's aim is formation through a classical framework: mission statements and philosophy stress formation, virtue, and the truth/goodness/beauty triad within a classical curriculum. - Curriculum emphasizes literature, writing, and critical thinking within a classical milieu; explicit Great Books language appears in the broader classical education literature the school aligns with. Public materials describe a literature-and-critical-thinking emphasis and a classically designed curriculum. - Pedagogy signals include conversation-based learning and smaller classes; explicit Socratic/seminar practices are not always named, but the classical approach and memory-based routines are indicated. - Parents and community are framed as partners; philosophy statements highlight partnerships with families in education.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Public materials describe a distinctively Christian, Bible-centered education rooted in classical pedagogy, including Bible classes and weekly chapel services.
 - A Note from the Head of School states that "The Bible is integrated into every subject we teach, and our staff are trained to 'teach Christianly' at all times."
 - Mission/Philosophy pages articulate God-centered aims and theology-driven formation (e.g., belief in biblical truth guiding the instructional environment).
- Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis
 - Positive keywords present: theology, liturgy, worship, reverence, wonder, imago Dei, virtue, logos, biblical truth, Chapel, Gospel, faith-centered learning.
 - Negative keywords: none evident in public materials.
 - These positives align with the Positive Keyword Indicators for this element (truth/goodness/beauty, theology, liturgy, reverence, wonder, imago Dei). See also the Six Essential Elements lexicon for include terms like truth, beauty, reverence, liturgy, worship, theology.

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- Why this rating
 - The materials consistently frame education as a Biblical/theological enterprise with liturgical and communal elements (chapel, worship), demonstrating transcendental/real FO foundations rather than secular or relativistic aims. The alignment with demonstrated keywords supports CLASSICAL in this category.

Element 2: Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The school's mission and philosophy emphasize formation, virtue, wisdom, and human flourishing, not simply job preparation. Public statements describe formation through a classical curriculum and the pursuit of the true, good, and beautiful.
 - Statements like “equipping students to display and defend Truth” and the Lordship of Christ over hearts and minds indicate a teleological, transcendent end beyond mere information transfer.
- Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis
 - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, liberal education, classical mission, telos, scholé/contemplation, great conversation, pursuit of the true/good/beautiful.
 - Negative keywords: none observed.
 - The presence of formation, virtue, telos, and the pursuit of truth/goodness/beauty matches the positive indicators for this category. See the lexicon and Six Essential Elements lists for validation of these terms.
- Why this rating
 - Public materials consistently frame education as formation toward human excellence and virtue, with explicit reference to truth, goodness, and beauty as real and knowable, meeting the Classical standard for this category.

Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - CCAC describes a curriculum “rooted in the classical model” with emphasis on literature, writing, and critical thinking. The International/General program pages reference a classical design and a broad liberal-arts-informed approach.
 - The site's navigation includes The Classical Approach and other elements consistent with classical curriculum design, including preparation for higher education through CAPE and college guidance.
- Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis
 - Positive keywords present: literature, writing, critical thinking, classical, liberal education, great conversation (inferred from classical approach), primary sources/great books (aligned with classical tradition in the broader canon).
 - Negative keywords: none observed.
 - The affirmative presence of literature/writing/critical thinking and explicit classical framing aligns with the positive indicators for this category. See the Six Essentials lexicon for the expected curricular terms (grammar, logic, rhetoric; great books; classical heritage).
- Why this rating
 - The school's public materials frame curriculum as literary/linguistic development within a classical framework, with attention to formation in the liberal-arts tradition, consistent with CLASSICAL standards.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The CCAC materials emphasize smaller class sizes and conversation-based learning, and note a classically designed curriculum that supports memory and dialogue. Public descriptions mention conversation-based learning and a focus on close student-teacher connections.

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- While explicit naming of Socratic seminars or the full set of classical pedagogical methods (recitation, memorization, debate, etc.) is not consistently stated in public materials, the classical approach and opportunities for discussion are foregrounded.
 - Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis
 - Positive keywords present: conversation-based learning, restfulness/contemplation (implied by the classical pedagogy), memorization/recitation (not explicitly named but supported by the classical approach terminology in broader canon), small class size, teacher-student dialogue.
 - Negative keywords: none overtly present in public materials.
 - The lexicon for Pedagogy lists items like Socratic seminar, narration, chanting, restfulness (scholé), and debate as standard classical methods. CCAC shows some of these ideas (conversation-based learning, small classes) but does not consistently name all canonical elements (e.g., explicit Socratic seminars or extensive recitation). This partial alignment justifies SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than FULL CLASSICAL.
 - Why this rating
 - CCAC demonstrates clear classical bent in pedagogy (small classes, discussion-oriented learning) but lacks explicit, consistent articulation of all canonical classical methods (e.g., named Socratic seminars, routine memorization/narration in public materials). This yields a category rating of SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Element 5: Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The public materials emphasize that staff are trained to teach Christianly and to lead in a faith-centered context; articles and mission statements describe teachers as guides and mentors aligned with the school's theology and classical aims. However, explicit descriptions of the faculty as the “living curriculum” or as “portrait of a teacher” are not consistently documented in the public-facing materials.
 - There is evidence of a formal leadership and faculty structure (e.g., Mission/Vision, Faculty/Staff pages) but explicit “living curriculum” language or clear statements about faculty as exemplars of virtue and mentors are not consistently shown in visible content.
- Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis
 - Positive keywords present: mentor/teacher as guide (implied in “trained to teach Christianly,” and “faculty collaborate on topical courses”), living curriculum (not consistently present; where present in classical literature, not clearly reflected in CCAC public copy).
 - Negative keywords: none explicitly present.
 - According to the Six Essential Elements lexicon, classical faculty signals include “portrait of a teacher,” “living curriculum,” and “collegial, virtuous exemplars.” Those specific phrases are not consistently present in the CCAC public materials. This leads to a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL assessment for the Faculty category.
- Why this rating
 - The school presents faculty as aligned with a Christian/classical mission and capable of mentoring students, but the public-facing content does not consistently show the full “living curriculum” or the explicit portrait language that would push this to CLASSICAL. Hence SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The school explicitly frames partnerships with families in the educational process; mission/philosophy documents stress family partnerships and collaborative education. Public materials also show parent-focused engagement through events, chapel, and community activities, and emphasize a community-oriented, faith-based environment.
 - Additional content highlights parent involvement opportunities (e.g., events, donations) and the broader school-community ecosystem (chapel, community life, discussions, and service projects).

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- Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis
 - Positive keywords present: partnership with families, family in education, cooperative community, parental involvement, community events, open access to campus life (where described).
 - Negative keywords: none observed.
 - The Six Essentials lexicon lists “partnership with parents” and “parent formation” as positive indicators; CCAC’s materials align with these indicators. See the lexicon mapping for this category.
 - Why this rating
 - The materials present a clear model of family partnership and community engagement, aligning with CLASSICAL expectations for parents/community involvement.

Aggregate Assessment - Overall classification: CLASSICAL - Element 1: CLASSICAL - Element 2: CLASSICAL - Element 3: CLASSICAL - Element 4: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL - Element 5: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL - Element 6: CLASSICAL

- Rationale: Four categories meet CLASSICAL criteria, two categories are SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL due to partial or less explicit articulation of canonical classical pedagogy and faculty language. The aggregate balance strongly favors CLASSICAL.

What Would Move the Needle - For CCAC to move from SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL toward FULL CLASSICAL in Element 4 (Pedagogy) and Element 5 (Faculty): - Publish explicit, canonical classical teaching method language (e.g., named Socratic seminars, explicit use of memorization/recitation, narration, and seminar formats) in public materials. - Provide explicit statements and anecdotes about the faculty as the living curriculum, including portraits or profiles of teachers illustrating virtue, mastery, and mentorship (e.g., “portrait of a teacher” language, faculty collaboration as core to the curriculum). - Expand on the role of the faculty as mentors and exemplars with concrete examples (professional development in classical pedagogy, seminars, and teacher-led classical memory work) in public communications. - Increase explicit documentation of parent-co-teaching roles or formalized parent formation activities beyond general partnership language (e.g., classical book studies, liturgical gatherings, structured parent seminars). - Strengthen explicit articulation of Great Books or primary texts in the public curriculum descriptions, including examples of approved Great Books lists, to reinforce the Element 3 criterion.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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